

The church's one foundation

Text: Samuel J. Stone, *Lyra Fidelium*, 1866, alt.

Music: Samuel S. Wesley, *Selection of Psalms and Hymns*, 1864

AURELIA 76.76D

1 The church's one foundation is Jesus Christ her Lord.
2 Elect from every nation yet one o'er all the earth,
3 Though with a scornful wonder the world sees her oppressed,
4 'Mid toil and tribulation, and tumult of her war,
5 Yet she on earth hath union with God the Three-in-One,
She is his new creation by water and the word.
2 her charter of salvation: one Lord, one faith, one birth.
3 by schisms rent asunder, by heresies distressed,
4 she waits the consummation of peace forevermore,
5 and mystic sweet communion with those whose rest is won.
From heav'n he came and sought her to be his holy bride;
2 One holy name she blesses, partakes one holy food,
3 yet saints their watch are keeping, their cry goes up, "How long?"
4 till with the vision glorious her long-ling eyes are bless'd,
5 Oh, happy ones and holy! Lord, give us grace that we,
with his own blood he bought her, and for her life he died.
2 and to one hope she presses, with every grace endowed.
3 And soon the night of weeping shall be the morn of song.
4 and the great church victorious shall be the church at rest.
5 like them, the meek and lowly, on high may dwell with thee.